



although more expensive than online options, via the internet or mobile technology. Online advertising is more flexible, since it is not limited to a timed publication or broadcast. Response rates, which you need in order to figure out the return on your investment (ROI; see p.152), are also easier to accurately track with online advertising. Look at the pros and cons of each option to decide on the most effective and affordable way to reach your customers.

90% of US consumers say that adverts influence them to make a purchase

How Consumers View Advertising, Clutch, 2017

ONLINE ADVERTISING		
	PROS	CONS
 ADVERTS EMAILED IN NEWSLETTERS	› Relatively affordable. Requires good software and a list of email addresses › Offers ability to send out bulk emails › Easy to track the response rate	› Building a mailing list takes time; buying one in can be expensive › Adverts may not reach the right audience › Emails can be deleted or marked as spam
 PAY-PER-CLICK DISPLAY ADVERTISING	› Affordable, since you pay only when someone clicks on the ad › Can be visually eye-catching and build brand awareness › Makes it easy to target special interests/topics	› No guarantee that website users will click › Ad-blocking tools can prevent users from seeing adverts › Lower click-through rate than pay-per-click adverts on search engines (paid search ads)
 PAID SEARCH ADVERTISING	› Similarly affordable, since search engine charges only when visitors click on the ad › Success is the number of clicks so easy to track › Higher click-through rate than for other pay-per-click banner and display adverts	› Requires lots of testing to establish most effective key words › No guarantee that those who click will buy › No direct correlation between budget and results
 MOBILE ADVERTISING	› Generally cheap to develop › Quick and easy to track ad effectiveness › Can target specific demographic groups, thanks to geo-location technologies › Can engage individually with users	› Creating a consistent advertising campaign for different screen sizes and systems is tricky and can be costly › Users may be annoyed by the intrusion › Negative experiences are quickly shared
 SOCIAL MEDIA SPONSORSHIP	› Sponsoring a social media influencer who connects with your target audience raises awareness of your brand › A positive mention of your product or service encourages brand loyalty	› Large followings do not necessarily guarantee high engagement › The appeal of influencers—especially celebrities—can fluctuate
 SOCIAL MEDIA ADVERTS	› Easy to target a specific audience › Increased brand visibility and recognition › Cheaper than conventional advertising	› Continual posts and updates can distract user attention away from placed adverts › Requires constant monitoring to maintain users' interest and find new users